



THANKSGIVING

TIBET'S EXILED SPIRITUAL leader the Dalai Lama offers prayers at the Nizamuddin Chilla, a Sufi shrine in Delhi. As a gesture of thanksgiving in the 50th year of his arrival in India, the Dalai Lama went to different places of worship to pray for peace and happiness for the citizens of his adopted homeland.



JUSTICE KATJU HAS SHOT DOWN A MUSLIM STUDENT'S PLEA THAT HE SHOULD BE ALLOWED TO SPORT A BEARD IN SCHOOL.

DELHI | Clean Justice

It's a ruling that's bound to raise the hackles of pseudo-secularists in the country. On March 30, the Supreme Court rejected the plea of a Muslim student, Mohammad Salim, that he should be allowed to sport a beard in his convent school. Justice Markandey Katju said, "Secularism cannot be overstretched and Talibanisation of the country cannot be permitted." Salim of Nirmala Convent Higher Secondary School in Madhya Pradesh sought quashing of the school regulation requiring students to be clean-shaven. "Tomorrow a girl student may say that she wants to wear a burqa. Can we allow it?" Katju said, adding that he was a secularist. "We should strike a balance between rights and personal beliefs. We cannot overstretch secularism." Salim's counsel Justice (retd) B.A. Khan argued that sporting a beard was an indispensable part of Islam. Katju wasn't impressed. "But you (Khan) don't sport a beard," he said. Case dismissed. ■